[illegible]

TOP SECRET

24th Meeting

TOP SECRET

COPY NO. 40

STATE-WAR-NAVY COORDINATING COMMITTEE

Minutes of the Meeting held in Room 200,
State Department Building,
on Wednesday, 12 September 1945, at 1500.

MEMBERS PRESENT

Mr. H. Freeman Matthews, Acting Chairman

Mr. John J. McCloy

Mr. Artemus L. Gates

OTHERS PRESENT

STATE

Mr. John Carter Vincent

Mr. Loy Henderson (Item 2 only)

Mr. Gordon P. Merriam (Item 2 only)

Dr. Hugh Borton

Mr. John O. Bell (Item 2 only)

Mr. Walter C. Dowling (Item 9 only)

NAVY

Mr. Francis X. Downey

Captain Lorenzo S. Sabin

Captain R. L. Dennison

Mr. Carl McGowan (Item 2 only)

WAR

Major Gen. John H. Hilldring

Brig. Gen. F. N. Roberts

Brig. Gen. G. F. Schulgen

Brig. Gen. C. M. Spofford (Item 9 only)

Col. Harrison A. Gerhardt

Col. C. Stanton Babcock

Col. H. A. Byroade

Lt. Col. Davidson Sommers

Lt. Col. Harry R. Snyder (Item 2 only)

SECRETARIAT

Colonel Charles W. McCarthy (War)

Commander Alvin F. Richardson (Navy)

Mr. Raymond E. Cox (State)

Mr. Harold W. Moseley (State)

Colonel Paul G. Pennoyer (War)

Lt. Comdr. John D. Rockefeller, III (Navy)

Lt. Comdr. John C. Geilfuss (Navy)

Lieutenant Hugh D. Farley (Navy)

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET [illegible] -19-6
from [illegible], [illegible] Dept.
Name K. Kuen
Date 6-15-66

TOP SECRET

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: G. W. Dowling NNFD DATE 1-28-72

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: [illegible] of 5-19-61
from James F. Burke, State Dept.
Name [illegible]
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: GLDowling NNFD DATE 1-28-72

TOP SECRET

1. MINUTES OF PREVIOUS MEETING

The minutes of the 23rd meeting were approved without amendment.

2. CONSTRUCTION OF A MILITARY AIRFIELD AT DHAHRAN (SWNCC 19/19; Agenda Item #1)

MR. GATES asked whether this report had been cleared with the Air Coordinating Committee. MR. HENDERSON answered in the negative, but explained that the substance of the report had been approved by the Civil Aeronautics Board and the Aviation Division of the State Department and that both of them felt Air Coordinating Committee consideration was unnecessary.

MR. McCLOY stated that the paper concerned the War Department in two respects. First, he felt that the report should be clarified so that it does not appear that the War and Navy Departments are recommending completion of the project from the point of view of military interest. Actually, he stated, all three Departments were agreeing that it is in the national interest. Although there is no immediate military interest, there is a long range military interest in protecting the oil reserves, having a foothold in a strategic area, and having some military officers familiar with the area. He recommended changes in paragraphs 8, 9, and 10 of the Conclusions of SWNCC 19/19 and to the fourth paragraph of the Memorandum for the President (Appendix "D") in order to provide for government rather than War Department responsibility and to provide for Presidential determination that the War Department act for the government in this regard. MR. HENDERSON felt the changes acceptable, provided the word "undertaken" is replaced by "completed" wherever used with reference to construction of the airfield, since the preliminary steps have already been taken. MR. McCLOY accepted this suggestion.

Secondly, MR. McCLOY stated that the War Department is concerned as to its right to use its present appropriations for construction of the field. He explained that the appropriation provides for construction of flying fields for military use and

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: [illegible] 5-19-61
from J[illegible] F. Burke, State Dept.
Name K. Duer
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: G.G. Dowling NNFD DATE 1-28-72

it is debateable whether construction of the Dhahran airfield meets this requirement now that the Pacific war is over. He stated that the War Department was reviewing this question of legality and would advise the Committee as to its decision promptly.

MR. MATTHEWS agreed that if there is a question of legality, this should be brought to the attention of the President. MR. McCLOY pointed out that presidential approval could not solve the legal problem. MR. HENDERSON felt that if it is necessary to obtain new funds from Congress for this purpose there might be so much delay that the project might have to be dropped. GENERAL HILLDRING explained that the War Department is submitting a request for new appropriations on September 24th and felt that funds for the Dhahran field might be included therein. MR. McCLOY agreed to expedite decision on the legal question so that funds could be thus obtained, if necessary.

THE COMMITTEE:

a. Agreed not to refer SWNCC 19/19 to the Air Coordinating Committee;

b. Approved SWNCC 19/19, after accepting the amendments of paragraphs 8, 9, and 10 of the Conclusions and paragraph 4 of Appendix "D" proposed by Mr. McCloy, subject to determination by the War Department that it can use presently appropriated funds for construction of the field;

c. Agreed that in the event the War Department determines that it cannot legally expend present appropriations for this purpose, the paper would be referred back to the Subcommittee for the Near and Middle East for reconsideration.

3. MILITARY ASSISTANCE TO CHINA

MR. McCLOY stated that Dr. T. V. Soong is in Washington, seeking a commitment from the United States as to military aid to be rendered to China. He explained that Dr. Soong had seen the President with Mr. Acheson and had been told that the State, War, and Navy Departments were urgently considering the problem.

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: [illegible] 5-19-61
from [illegible] F. [illegible], State Dept.
Name K. Owen
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: NNFS DATE 1-28-72

He pointed out that Dr. Soong asserted that a commitment for the equipping and training of 90 Chinese divisions was made at the Cairo Conference as against a request for 120. The present program provides for 39 divisions. MR. MATTHEWS stated that the existence of a commitment for 90 divisions is questionable. MR. McCLOY agreed. He explained that the War Department is not certain either as to the desirable size of the Chinese army or as to the number of divisions the United States is in a position to equip. Dr. Soong has stated that 39 divisions are insufficient. However, the prevailing War Department view is that it would be unwise to equip too large a Chinese army since it would be difficult for the Chinese to maintain, and that a smaller army which can be made mobile through use of air transport is preferable. He stated that the Army is not sure whether the Chinese army should be more than the presently approved 39 divisions and desires to study the question further, with General Wedemeyer's advice, and to have a prior determination as to the extent of available surplus equipment.

MR. McCLOY then read a draft memorandum for presentation to the President by the Acting Secretary of State, with a proposed statement for Dr. Soong appended. In the memorandum, he explained, the three Departments would recommend continuation of the 39 divisions program with further study to be given to the question whether or not the program be expanded. It also covers provision of certain naval craft and equipment for the Chinese air force. The memorandum also deals with the establishment of a U.S. advisory mission, already agreed upon by the President in principle, but states that its size, composition, and functions are subject to further study.

MR. VINCENT agreed with the presentation of such a memorandum and felt the proposed draft was satisfactory. He stated that the purpose was to agree to carry out the 39 division program but not permit pressure by Dr. Soong to force an immediate decision to expand the program to 90 divisions or any

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: [illegible] 5-19-61
from James P. Burke, State Dept.
Name K. Owen
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: NNFS DATE 1-28-72

other definite number. He questioned, however, whether a sentence should not be added with respect to the proposed mission, reserving decision as to whether it should be established by the United States or by the Chinese. He also suggested that reference be made in the memorandum to "liberated areas of China including Manchuria and Formosa" rather than "Manchuria, Formosa and the liberated areas of China". MR. McCLOY accepted these suggestions.

CAPTAIN SABIN suggested that the memorandum as drafted committed us to provision of more than 39 divisions and suggested insertion of the words "if any" when reference to assistance beyond that program is mentioned.

MR. GATES suggested that reference be made to the Joint Chiefs of Staff rather than General Wedemeyer in cases where further consideration is to be given in order to protect him from pressure from the Chinese. After discussion of the various points where this change might be made, MR. GATES agreed that no change be made except to specify the Joint Chiefs of Staff as one of the agencies to consider the program further.

CAPTAIN DENNISON called attention to the provision relating to the furnishing of naval craft and stated that the Navy would have to determine whether we should commit ourselves to delivery of naval craft beyond those already delivered. MR. DOWNEY agreed to take this up at once and advise the Committee.

MR. GATES asked as to the relationship of this memorandum to the pending Far Eastern Subcommittee study in the same field. MR. McCLOY suggested that this memorandum serve as a starting point for that study.

THE COMMITTEE:

a. Approved the memorandum to the President, and the appended statement after amending them as suggested by Mr. Vincent with respect to the reference to Manchuria, by Captain Sabin, and by Mr. Gates with respect to mention of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, subject to review of the provisions as to naval craft by the Navy Member, and of provisions as to the character of the mission by the State Member;

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: Ltr of 5-19-6
from James F. Burke, State Dept.
Name K. Duer
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: G.G. Dowling NNFD DATE 1-28-72

b. Agreed that the memorandum be presented to the President by Mr. Acheson, but that Committee approval of the memorandum should not be construed to prevent further revisions as to form which may be considered advisable by the State Department;

c. Agreed that this memorandum should be used by the Subcommittee for the Far East as the starting point for its study of our policy toward China;

d. Agreed that no discussion of this matter be held with Dr. Soong except by the President.

4. ALLIED CONTROL MACHINERY FOR THE JAPANESE EMPIRE (SWNCC 70/10; Agenda Item #3)

MR. DOWNEY stated that he agreed with the paper but questioned whether it is realistic in view of our desire to encourage the furnishing of occupation forces by other powers for use in Japan. He felt it difficult to draft a paper at this time which will protect our interests and also be acceptable to others. MR. McCLOY agreed. He pointed out that the British have already requested participation in the planning for control of Japan. He was of the opinion also that we should be more liberal about letting the others in. He felt, however, that this paper is satisfactory with certain changes in paragraphs 6 and 8 and omission of paragraph 7 of the Conclusions. He also suggested addition of a paragraph in the Conclusions to the effect that the Supreme Commander is viewed by the United States as an "implementing agent who acts in accord with policies provided by the Allied Powers through the United States Government". However, after discussion, he agreed that this addition was unnecessary. He stated that our Allies are disposed to give us the leading hand and this paper is as close as we can come to maintaining our leadership and still giving them a voice.

MR. McCLOY suggested that this paper might be presented to our Allies in order to induce them to make suggestions and not to object to our direct action in Japan. MR. MATTHEWS stated that it would be preferable to hold the paper in reserve for

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: Ltr of 5-19-61
from [illegible] F. Burke, State Dept.
Name K. Owen
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: G.G. Dowling NNFD DATE 1-28-72

submission to our Allies as the United States position when they begin pressing for an agreement on control machinery.

THE COMMITTEE:

a. Amended the paper as suggested by Mr. McCloy;

b. Agreed to forward the paper, as amended to the Joint Chiefs of Staff for comment;

c. Approved the paper, as amended, subject to further consideration in the light of such comments as may be received from the Joint Chiefs of Staff;

d. Agreed that the paper, when finally approved, be held by the State Department for use as the basis of a United States proposal in the event that the question of Japanese control machinery is pressed by our Allies.

5. DISSEMINATION OF DIRECTIVES ISSUED TO THE SUPREME COMMANDER TO OUR ALLIES AND TO THE PUBLIC: PUBLICATION OF MESSAGE AS TO SUPREME COMMANDER'S AUTHORITY (SWNCC 181/2; Agenda Item #5)

MR. MATTHEWS, in connection with discussion of SWNCC 70/1C raised a question as to informing our Allies concerning directives issued to the Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers. He pointed out that, if we decide on such action, we must consider whether to inform only the three major Allies or all nations which are associated with us, whether all or only selected directives should be circulated and the procedure by which we are to advise the Allies. He added that, so far, we have told them nothing.

MR. GATES asked whether we should not release such directives to the public as well as to our Allies. MR. MATTHEWS felt it essential to reveal directives to our Allies before releasing them for publication. GENERAL HILLDRING agreed and pointed out that if we do not inform our Allies directly they will be sure to learn about the directives indirectly. The results would be very undesirable. MR. MATTHEWS suggested that, in the future, the State-War-Navy Coordinating Committee decide at the time it acts upon directives whether they are to be revealed to our Allies and whether they are to be given publicity.

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: Ltr of 5-19-61
from James P. Burke, State Dept.
Name K. Dunn
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: NARS DATE 1-28-72

The question of which Allies to inform was discussed. MR. McCLOY suggested that for the present only Russia, Great Britain and China be informed on directives issued and that after the others have been included in an advisory commission they too be informed. MR. MATTHEWS suggested that in cases where we intend to release to the public, all of the Powers whom we propose ultimately to have represented on the advisory commission be informed; in cases where release to the public is not planned, only the three principal Allies be informed. MR. McCLOY agreed with this.

SWNCC 181/2 was specifically discussed. MR. McCLOY and MR. MATTHEWS both felt presidential approval desirable before the message sent to General MacArthur is released to the press. MR. MATTHEWS also suggested that it be communicated to our Allies before release.

MR. McCLOY suggested publication of SWNCC 150/4, United States Initial Post-Defeat Policy Relating to Japan. COLONEL SOMMERS suggested that it might be desirable to omit the provision that, "in the event of differences of opinion among the principal Allied Powers, the policies of the United States will govern". MR. McCLOY suggested that it would be desirable to reveal this position to them now. MR. DOWNEY questioned whether the first paragraph entitled "Purpose of this Document" should not be revised or eliminated. MR. McCLOY agreed that revision would be desirable and suggested that the entire paper be edited. MR. MATTHEWS suggested that this be done by the Subcommittee for the Far East. He also urged that presidential approval be obtained prior to publication. GENERAL HILLDRING also suggested that General MacArthur's comments be obtained prior to publication.

MR. MATTHEWS proposed that the Subcommittee for the Far East review all directives and policy statements already issued or to be issued to the Supreme Commander and to make recommendations as to disclosure to our Allies and as to publication.

GENERAL ROBERTS asked whether Joint Chiefs of Staff approval of publication of SWNCC 150/4 should be sought prior to presenting the question to the President, but it was agreed that

TOP SECRET

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: Ltr of 5-19-61
from James P. Burke, State Dept.
Name K. Owen
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: PG Dowling NNFD DATE 1-28-72

this would not be necessary.

THE COMMITTEE:

a. Agreed that it is desirable to disclose to our Allies and to release to the public directives and policy statements issued to the Supreme Commander but that this question be specifically decided as to each such directive or policy statement;

b. Agreed that, in all cases where release to the public is decided upon, the directive or policy be communicated in advance to our three principal Allies and to the other associated Allies but that, for the present, where release to the public is not contemplated, such communication be confined to the three principal Allies;

c. Agreed that the State Department implement decisions of the Committee as to communication to our Allies and as to release to the public;

d. Agreed that the message at the Appendix to SWNCC 181/2 be communicated to our Allies and be released to the public subject to presidential approval of these actions;

e. Agreed that, subject to approval by the President, SWNCC 150/4 be communicated to our Allies and be released to the public after suitable editing and after obtaining General MacArthur's comments on this action; and directed the Subcommittee for the Far East to revise the paper for these purposes and submit its recommended revisions to the Committee;

f. Directed the Subcommittee for the Far East to review all approved directives and policy statements and to submit to the Committee its recommendations as to communication to our Allies and as to release to the public;

g. Directed the Subcommittee for the Far East to include in all future reports containing directive to the Supreme Commander or statements of U.S. policy a recommendation as to communication thereof to our Allies and as to release to the public.

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: Ltr of 5-19-61
from James P. Burke, State Dept.
Name K. Queen
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: NARS DATE 1-28-72

6. DISCUSSION OF OCCUPATION POLICIES WITH THE BRITISH

MR. McCLOY stated that General Macready had already approached the War Department on the question of occupation policies and that the British had introduced a paper in the Combined Chiefs of Staff on this subject. He felt that the Combined Chiefs of Staff is not the proper forum for discussion of Japanese policy. General Macready has been so informed. He suggested the desirability of authorizing him and General Hilldring to discuss Japanese policy informally with General Macready and thus have an exchange of ideas without issuing a general invitation to all Powers to discuss such policies with us. MR. MATTHEWS agreed that this might well reduce rather than increase the pressure on us.

THE COMMITTEE:

a. Agreed that discussion of Japanese policy in the Combined Chiefs of Staff should be avoided;

b. Authorized representatives of the three Departments to discuss Japanese policy matters informally with British representatives in Washington.

7. U.S. PARTICIPATION IN SOUTHEAST ASIA COMMAND AFTER CESSATION OF JAPANESE RESISTANCE (SWNCC 177/1; Agenda Item #4)

MR. McCLOY and MR. GATES suggested that the Joint Chiefs of Staff comments contained in SWNCC 177/1 be approved. MR. MATTHEWS felt it very desirable, however, that the memorandum contained in the Enclosure to JCS 1494/1 (SWNCC 177/1) not be presented to the Combined Chiefs of Staff until the military agreement between the Supreme Allied Commander of Southeast Asia and the Thai Government is completed. He stated that he felt this would be accomplished in about two weeks.

THE COMMITTEE:

a. Approved SWNCC 177/1 but agreed that the memorandum in the Enclosure to JCS 1494/1 (SWNCC 177/1) not be communicated to the Combined Chiefs of Staff until the military agreement between the Supreme Allied Commander of Southeast

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: Ltr of 5-19-61
from James F. Burke, State Dept.
Name K. Owen
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: NWFD DATE 1-28-72

Asia and the Thai Government is completed;

b. Agreed to advise the Joint Chiefs of Staff of this action.

8. DISPOSITION OF COMBATANT VESSELS OF THE JAPANESE NAVY (SWNCC 186/1; Agenda Item #6)

MR. DOWNEY asked whether a question was involved here which required consultation with our Allies before directing Admiral Nimitz to destroy Japanese ships. MR. McCLOY agreed that paragraph numbered 2 of the Moscow Declaration of November 1, 1943 should be considered in connection with this question. MR. MATTHEWS felt it desirable to obtain an opinion as to our obligations under that declaration.

The question was raised whether, in view of the fact that the general policy statement on disposition of Japanese war material contained in SWNCC 58/9 provides for destruction of combat ships and is in Admiral Nimitz' hands, an interim message should be sent to him advising him to take no action toward destruction until advised.

THE COMMITTEE:

a. Agreed that Mr. Matthews would, as a matter of urgency, obtain an opinion from the State Department as to the necessity for consultation with our Allies on this subject in light of the Moscow Declaration;

b. Agreed to defer action until such opinion is received;

c. Agreed that the Joint Chiefs of Staff be notified that there will be a delay in forwarding a definitive answer to be transmitted to Admiral Nimitz.

9. TREATY OF PEACE WITH ITALY (SWNCC 155/1; Agenda Item #2)

The proposed military clauses of the Treaty with Italy were discussed.

MR. McCLOY indicated that although this may appear to be an easy treaty for Italy it seems proper under the circumstances. He stated it does not appear as if Italy would again become a menace to the peace of the world.

CLASSIFICATION CHANGED
To SECRET Authority: [illegible] of 5-19-61
from [illegible] State Dept.
Name K. Owen
Date 6-15-66

CLASSIFICATION CANCELLED BY AUTHORITY OF JCS MEMO 18-71
BY: PGDowling NNFD DATE 1-28-72

MR. GATES stated that he had no changes or additions to this paper but that if the remaining clauses of the Treaty raised questions on Pantelleria or other areas requiring the introduction of amendments by the Navy these would be raised subsequently.

It was felt that the paper should be submitted to the Joint Chiefs of Staff as a matter of priority.

THE COMMITTEE:

_a_. Approved SWNCC 155/1, subject to reconsideration in the light of such comments as may be received from the Joint Chiefs of Staff;

_b_. Directed that SWNCC 155/1 be referred to the Joint Chiefs of Staff for comment as a matter of priority.